

Outlook

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Follow-up: the same arrears amount may need a different response

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

Collections needs to distinguish temporary operational failures, short-term cash-flow stress and sustained affordability problems. The discussion is currently being driven by anecdotes, and the teams involved are describing the same customers differently.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if bank-side processing issues are entering collections?
2. What evidence would instead support that some customers recover after payday?
3. How do we rule out that repeat failures and complaints indicate deeper stress?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use May 2025 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards which treatment path, contact tone and escalation should apply. A useful output would be a control view with the exceptions, owner and reason each item was included.

Use collections cases, promises to pay and recovery payments; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions; the latest closed loan files available by the request date, including affordability, pricing and origination risk fields. One caution: The data contains behavioural indicators, not a complete vulnerability or hardship assessment.

Regards